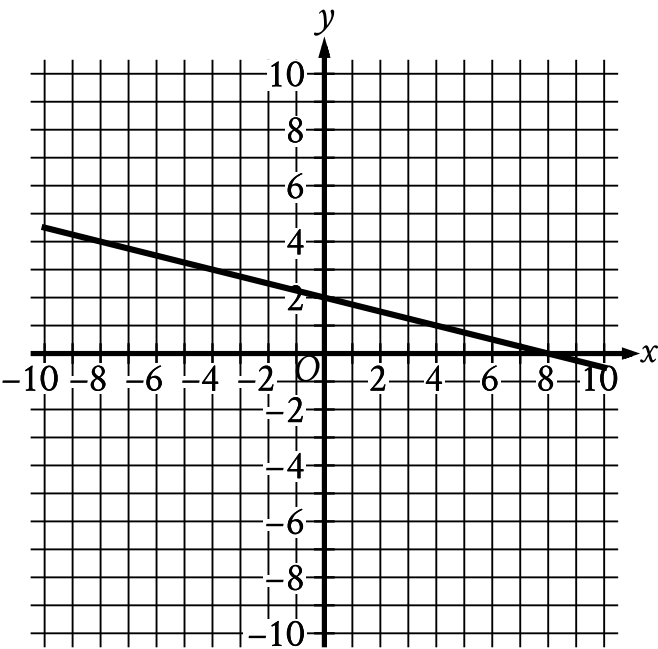


Assessment	Test	Domain	Skill	Difficulty
SAT	Math	Algebra	Linear equations in two variables	Hard

Question



The graph of $y = f(x) + 14$ is shown. Which equation defines function f ?

Answer

- A. $f(x) = -\frac{1}{4}x - 12$
- B. $f(x) = -\frac{1}{4}x + 16$
- C. $f(x) = -\frac{1}{4}x + 2$
- D. $f(x) = -\frac{1}{4}x - 14$

Correct Answer: A

Rationale

Choice A is correct. An equation for the graph shown can be written in slope-intercept form $y = mx + b$, where m is the slope of the graph and its y -intercept is $(0, b)$. Since the y -intercept of the graph shown is $(0, 2)$, the value of b is 2 . Since the graph also passes through the point $(4, 1)$, the slope can be calculated as $\frac{1-2}{4-0}$, or $-\frac{1}{4}$. Therefore, the value of m is $-\frac{1}{4}$. Substituting $-\frac{1}{4}$ for m and 2 for b in the equation $y = mx + b$ yields $y = -\frac{1}{4}x + 2$. It's given that an equation for the graph shown is $y = f(x) + 14$. Substituting $f(x) + 14$ for y in the equation $y = -\frac{1}{4}x + 2$ yields $f(x) + 14 = -\frac{1}{4}x + 2$. Subtracting 14 from both sides of this equation yields $f(x) = -\frac{1}{4}x - 12$.

Choice B is incorrect and may result from conceptual or calculation errors.

Choice C is incorrect and may result from conceptual or calculation errors.

Choice D is incorrect and may result from conceptual or calculation errors.